

It can scale and adapt along with the access to the hybrid infrastructure. This 'software only' solution that is delivered as a service positively impacts costs by significantly reducing TCO and delivering a faster ROI.

Q What strategies should a company adopt to secure cloud deployments in today's market?

Corporates need to gain a clear understanding of the shared model of security while doing cloud deployments. Typically, the cloud provider secures the hardware infrastructure, while the company needs to ensure that the network access, the operating system security, and the application security are handled effectively. As such, the cloud providers secure the underlying physical infrastructure, ensuring the logical data isolation between different customers, and so on.

Also, corporates need to invest in the skills improvement of their workforce so that they understand these changes and keep an open mind in terms of looking out for innovative security solutions — be it from startups or established vendors.

Q How does InstaSafe help to educate the market about cyber security?

We have partnered with leading organisations like the Data Security Council of India (DSCI), the Cloud Security Alliance (CSA) and the Cloud Computing Innovation Council of India (CCICI) to promote awareness of security at multiple levels, starting with CIOs.

Q Have the recent partnerships with CSA and CCICI enabled InstaSafe to enhance awareness of cloud-based security solutions in the Indian market?

Along with our partnerships with cloud security organisations, last year we published a pioneering survey on cloud and security adoption in India. We are continuing this study in 2017 and will

do so in the years to come, aiming to provide an authoritative benchmark for how the country and local organisations have evolved in cloud deployments and cloud security.

Q How do you view VPNs (virtual private networks) in the security landscape?

VPNs have been around for 20 years with minimum innovation. They have limited utility by themselves, as they do not have much flexibility in deployments for hybrid set-ups. In many cases, they do not even allow for fine-tuned, multiple-level access to resources on the organisation's network, as they operate on an 'all-or-nothing' principle for access to the assigned network. SDP solutions offer the flexibility and functionality required for today's set-up, vastly improving the security posture of any enterprise, both of which VPNs cannot fulfil.

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Q What are your views on India's national cyber security policy? Do you think such legal developments are vital for the country?

A national cyber security policy is certainly vital for the country. Till date, we do not have a formal, legally enforceable cyber security policy, but there has been some talk of it being under consideration. We clearly need a legal framework that would address, for example, the basic requirement that data should reside within the country. This would make it possible

to prosecute the people responsible for data breaches, within India.

Q Where does open source sit in the world of cloud-based security solutions?

The security industry has to look at using open standards and the concept of sharing as key strategies. Going forward, open source will inevitably become a key element of security as people have to turn to a code base that is easily reusable, and more importantly, has been worked on, tweaked and tested for bugs by a large installed base of users.

Q Do you believe in the philosophy of releasing the code to the public?

Certainly. The cloud security industry is moving to open source because of a large number of crowd-tested solutions out there that are open source. Hypervisors and Apache Web servers are open source, while security protocols like SSL are open. They have been time-tested and crowd-tested, so they have become better than closed source software.

Q Is it lucrative to opt for a career around cyber security?

Most certainly. As a growing shortage of security professionals exists in the market today, there is clearly an opportunity.

Q Lastly, where do you see the world of cloud security moving in the next five years?

What we are going to be seeing is that as network speeds improve, IoT devices such as small little sensors located in industrial and consumer infrastructure will proliferate faster than smartphones and other end user devices. All of these IoT and IIoT sensors will be monitored and managed using cloud set-ups. This will create an environment where cyber security will become ubiquitous, since it will then directly impact the safety and well-being of humanity. 